Effective Date:
01/01/2023

Background:
All Supplemental Security Income (SSI) and State Supplementary Payment (SSP) recipients received a Cost-of-Living Adjustment (COLA) effective on January 1st.

Policy:
The amount of the SSI and SSP income received by a CalFresh household (HH) will be adjusted automatically in the CalFresh budget in CalWIN effective January 1st 2023. Any changes in the benefit allotment will take effect February 2023. The following reports have been generated to identify cases that require follow up action:

Report	Description
COLA Exception Report	This report lists exception errors encountered on cases during the automated run process.
COLA Excluded Report	This list identifies the following case circumstances: • CalWIN did not receive an income record from California Department of Health Care Services (DHCS). • The income received exceeded the maximum limit for SSI. • The income on the case already had an effective begin date of 01/01/2023.
COLA Online Correspondence Report	This report provides client correspondence generated during the automated run.

Actions Required:
The COLA Exception and the COLA Online Correspondence Reports will only be generated once and must be acted on upon receipt. The required actions to take on these reports are included below:

Report	Action Required
COLA Exception Report	Review the case, correct the exception error, and authorize.
COLA Online Correspondence Report	Review all correspondence that is held in the print queue, delete unnecessary correspondence, and before mailing required correspondence, complete manual variables.

The COLA excluded report will be generated monthly to assist in identifying cases with a Semi-Annual Report (SAR) or recertification due. This report will only continue to be generated until all excluded cases have been addressed. The required actions to take on this report are included below:

Report	Action Required
COLA Excluded Report	Staff will use the Medi-Cal Eligibility Data System (MEDS) and the Income and Eligibility Verification System (IEVS) to update the case record and exclude any lump sum(s) and SSI/SSP recoupments. If questionable or discrepant information is found contact the HH to request additional verification.

Excluded Income:
The following payments must be excluded from the CalFresh budget:

- Retroactive SSI/SSP payments received.
- Recoupments from SSI/SSP.
- Transitional CalFresh (TCF) cases will not have SSI/SSP amounts updated until TCF period ends.

Please refer to 63-224 for additional information on excluded income.

Program Impacts:
No impact

References:
ACIN: I-74-22, I-74-22E

Sunset Date:
12/31/2023

Approval for Release:



Assmaa Elayyat, Chief
Self-Sufficiency Services